Purring softly, dreaming boldly

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/55963300.

Rating:
Teen And Up Audiences

Archive Warning:
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by Mochikiwis

Summary

Catra's still wrestling with nightmares, but she's making progress, with Adora by her side, because, well, love conquers all.

Notes

I can't believe I've never posted any fics for catradora here, that should be a crime. Arrest me.

Adora lies sprawled on the lush grass, Catra nestled comfortably in her lap. Exhausted from a day of stirring up mischief, Catra is indulging in a well-earned catnap. The feline's gentle purrs fill the air, and her tail flicks lazily, a sign of contentment as she enjoys a rare peaceful dream.

Adora often reflected on whether Catra had suffered nightmares during their time in the Fright Zone, nightmares where Adora played the central role. Did Catra harbor any guilt? Was there a part of her that longed to escape, even subconsciously?

Adora herself had been haunted by such dreams.

She had hoped that knowing Catra shared in the torment would help her see a glimmer of the Catra she used to love, something to cling to that would ease her resentment.

Now, in the quiet of many nights, Adora is jolted awake by Catra's piercing screams, her frantic tossing and turning. The sight of Catra fleeing from her comforting touch is heart-wrenching.

Adora comprehends the deep-seated reasons behind Catra's aversion to physical contact in those moments.

Catra's nightmares aren't mere figments designed to evoke guilt—they are relived memories, vivid and painful, of the times she inflicted harm on Adora. If Catra cannot find it within herself to accept Adora's gentle reassurances after being plunged into such turmoil, Adora cannot hold it against her. She understands that Catra's mistrust isn't directed at her, but at the haunting echoes of her own self.

Adora's brow furrows gently as she gazes down at Catra's face, still captivated by the serene expression that feels so new and rare. Curled up beside her, Catra appears so small and fragile, a stark contrast to the towering figure of anger and bitterness she once embodied. It's a transformation that never ceases to amaze Adora—how that intimidating presence of fury and defiance could

dissolve into the vulnerable girl she cherishes more than anything in the universe.

Yet, Adora knows this metamorphosis wasn't effortless. Catra worked tirelessly to change, fighting against her own stubborn nature. Despite the challenges, Adora couldn't be prouder of her. Most importantly, Catra seemed genuinely happier now, a sight that filled Adora with immense joy.

As Adora's gaze begins to wander towards the cerulean canopy above, a subtle movement beneath her catches her attention. Catra stirs, a slight frown marring her previously tranquil expression. Before Adora can react, Catra's eyes snap open, and she sits up with a gasp, her breath coming in rapid bursts.

"Hey," Adora's voice is soft, a gentle reassurance as she extends a tentative hand towards Catra, "it's alright. Just a dream. You're here with me."

Catra's gaze fixates on Adora, her tense demeanor visibly easing at the sight of her. A faint blush creeps onto her cheeks, overshadowed by a wave of embarrassment, which she expresses through muttered grumbles.

Adora's smile widens as she gently guides Catra back onto her lap, her fingers tenderly tracing patterns in Catra's hair. "Feeling better now?"

"I was foolish to believe my happiness would last," Catra murmurs, burying her face against Adora's thigh.

"Don't say that," Adora's voice is soft but firm, her hand moving to stroke Catra's back soothingly. "We'll find a way to make it last, I promise."

Catra lets out a frustrated groan. "You and your relentless optimism since the war ended."

Adora arches an eyebrow, a playful glint in her eyes. "Is my optimism really that irritating to you and your perpetual

negativity?"

Frowning at first, Catra's expression softens into a smile, her eyes reflecting warmth as she looks up at Adora. "Yes, it really is. But I suppose it's part of your charm, as annoyingly dumb as it may be."

Adora, with an affectionate grin, rolls her eyes playfully, her fingers tenderly cradling Catra's cheeks as she leans in, their lips meeting in a gentle kiss.

The moment holds a newness, a freshness, tinged with a hint of trepidation that should make it daunting, yet strangely, it feels like the most natural thing in the world. It's as though destiny has finally aligned their paths, after years of strife and conflict, leading them to this point of tender connection. It's not just a kiss; it's a balm, a remedy for the wounds of the past, a step towards healing that feels long overdue.

As Catra's purring fills the air once more, Adora resists the urge to tease, memories flooding back of the playful scratches she earned the last time she poked fun at it.

That sound, Catra's purr, is a familiar melody to Adora's ears. Even in the days of the Horde, it was a constant presence, the soundtrack of their shared moments. Catra purred when she stealthily migrated from her top bunk to curl up at Adora's feet. She purred as Adora tenderly brushed her hair, and even as she leaned against Adora's shoulder while they observed the soldiers toiling below from their habitual rooftop perch.

The absence of that sound during their time as enemies was a painful void, but now, as it returns, Adora finds herself welcoming it back into her life with open arms. It's a small comfort, yet one that speaks volumes of the journey they've undertaken and the love that still binds them together.

Adora gently brushes her lips against Catra's as she pulls back from the kiss, a warm whisper escaping her, "You better get used

to my relentless positivity, 'cause you promised me forever, remember?"

Catra chuckles softly, a glint of affection in her eyes. "Oh, don't worry, I'll tough it out."

...

"Hey!" Before they lay eyes on her, Glimmer's voice pierces the air, tinged with frazzled nerves and edginess, like a storm brewing on the horizon. Her cheeks flushed as her magenta hair, popping up next to them in a flash, arms crossed. "Adora, your vexing feline of a girlfriend just turned the throne room curtains into confetti! Again! Do you even realize how many times I've had to replace them?!"

Catra springs to her feet, pulling Adora along. "We've gotta scram, like, right now. Melog, a little assistance, buddy!"

In response, Melog swiftly approaches, enveloping Catra and Adora with its shimmering aura, rendering them invisible.

Adora chuckles, clutching Catra's hand as they dart away, Melog trailing behind. "I can't believe you."

Glimmer lets out an exasperated groan. "That's just not fair, seriously!"

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